AA-C-571G
December 16, 1982
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. AA-C-571F
March 31, 1978

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

COT, FOLDING

This specification is approved for use by the Commissioner, Office of Personal Property, General Services Administration, for use of all Federal Agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for one type of aluminum frame folding cot (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

QQ-S-781	-	Strapping, Steel, and Seals
QQ-Z-325	-	Zinc Coating, Electrodeposited, Requirements For
UU-P-268	-	Paper, Kraft, Wrapping

Federal Standards:

FED-STD-123	-	Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies)
FED-STD-751	-	Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

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FSC 7105

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(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal standardization documents, and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit loads
MIL-STD-1188 - Commercial Packaging of Supplies and Equipment

DRAWINGS

US ARMY NATICK RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT LABORATORIES

2-5-65 - Cot Folding; Method of Folding for Shipment
2-5-72 - Cot, Folding; Assembly Complete

(Copies of Military Specifications, Standards, and Drawings required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials and components (see 6.6). Materials and components shall conform to the referenced specifications and requirements specified herein. Materials not definitely specified shall be of the quality normally used by the manufacturer for the frame and cover, provided the end item complies with all provisions of this specification.

3.1.1 Hardware, miscellaneous. Bolts, nuts and washers shall be steel, commercial quality, of the size and type shown on the drawings. Rivets shall be steel, commercial quality, semitubular or solid type, except the rivet used on the strap shall be brass of commercial quality, tubular, flathead, with brass cap. All steel miscellaneous hardware shall have a corrosion-resisting plating in accordance with manufacturer's commercial practice. The rivets shall be of sufficient length to provide a minimum of 1/8 inch for peening or rolling, as applicable. Blind rivets shall be aluminum, commercial type, 3/16-inch body, 5/8-inch head, break stem, large flange (see 6.5).

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3.2 Construction. The construction of the cots shall conform to the requirements shown on Drawing 2-5-72 and as specified herein. At the option of the supplier, covers shall be fabricated from either cotton duck or from nylon duck. The cots shall be capable of being assembled, disassembled and compactly folded as intended without causing damage to any component.

3.2.1 Stitches, seams and stitching. Stitching shall conform to stitch type 301 of FED-STD-751, 8 to 10 stitches per inch.

3.2.1.1 Automatic stitching. Automatic stitching machines may be used to perform any of the stitch patterns provided the requirements for the stitch pattern, stitches per inch, and size and type of thread are met; and at least three tying, overlapping or backstitches are used to secure the ends of stitching.

3.2.1.2 Type 301 stitching. Ends of stitching shall be backstitched or overstitched not less than 1 inch except where ends are turned under or caught in other seams and stitching. Thread tensions shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching resulting in loose bobbin or top thread or excessively tight stitching resulting in puckering of the materials sewn. The lock shall be imbedded in the materials sewed.

3.2.1.2.1 Repairs of type 301 stitching. Repairs of type 301 stitching shall be as follows:

a. When thread breaks or bobbin run-outs occur during stitching, the stitching shall be repaired by restarting the stitching a minimum of one inch (1/2 inch for box-x) back of the end of the stitching. 1/

b. Thread breaks, or two or more consecutive skipped or run-off stitches noted during inspection of the item (in-process or end item) shall be repaired by overstitching. The stitching shall start a minimum of one inch in back of the defective area (1/2 inch on box-x), continue over the defective area and continue a minimum of one inch (1/2 inch on box-x) beyond the defective area onto the existing stitching. Loose or excessively tight stitching shall be repaired by removing the defective stitching without damaging the materials and restitching in the required manner. 1/

1/ When making the above repairs, the ends of the stitching are not required to be backstitched.

3.2.2 Setting of end clips. The webbing shall be inserted the full depth of the clips. The clips shall be securely attached without cutting the webbing and the webbing shall lie flat at the point of entrance.

3.2.3 Setting of rivets.

3.2.3.1 Tubular rivets and caps. Holes for inserting tubular rivets in straps shall be formed by the rivet when driven into the material and shall not be prepunched. All rivets shall be securely and neatly set with a rivet cap and without causing damage to the webbing. Holes punched to receive blind rivets in the aluminum frame shall be smaller than the outside diameter of the rivet body so that the rivet must be forced through the hole.

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3.2.3.2 Solid or tubular rivets without caps. All rivets shall be properly driven with heads flush against steel stampings. The ends of solid rivets shall be peened without burrs or sharp edges. The ends of tubular rivets shall be firmly clinched with even metal distribution.

3.2.4 Steel stampings. The steel stampings (L's, S's and T's) shall be securely riveted or bolted as shown on the applicable drawings and the flanges of the stampings shall be pressed down and fitted tightly against the adjacent parts.

3.2.5 Plug, end. End plugs shall be riveted, pinned or cemented into the bottom of the legs and both ends of the end rails to prevent removal. The adhesive, when used, shall be such, as recommended by the adhesive manufacturer for adherence of plastic to aluminum alloy.

3.3 Finish.

3.3.1 Aluminum alloy frame. Ends shall be cut clean and be free of sharp or rough edges. The rims of all holes shall be free of sharp or rough edges.

3.3.2 Plating. All steel stampings (L's, S's and T's) shall be zinc plated in accordance with type I, class 1 of QQ-Z-325.

3.4 Markings for identification.

3.4.1 Frame and cover. The identification marking shall be as specified on the applicable drawing.

3.5 Workmanship. Cloth components shall be clean and free of holes, cuts, tears, or cloth defects such as multiple floats or broken or missing yarns. Webbing and tapes shall contain no frayed or scalloped edges. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching and seam allowances shall be maintained with seams properly sewed so that no runoffs, twists, pleats or open seams shall result. Care shall be taken in sewing so that there shall be no needle chews. All thread ends shall be trimmed to 1/4 inch or less. Blind rivets shall be securely and neatly set. Metal components shall be free of burrs, sharp edges and corroded areas, and shall not be broken, malformed, or dented.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.2 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.2.2 In-process inspection. Examination shall be made to determine that the following are as specified:

(a) Webbing inserted the full depth of end clips (see 3.2.2).
(b) Holes punched to receive blind rivets (see 3.2.3.1).
(c) Setting of solid or tubular rivets (see 3.2.3.2).
(d) Setting of end plugs in bottom of legs and end rails of cots (see 3.2.5).

Whenever nonconformance is noted, correction shall be made to the items affected and the process. Parts which cannot be corrected shall be removed from production.

4.2.3 End item visual examination. The end item shall be examined for the defects listed in table I. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one cot. The sample unit shall be one cot. The inspection level shall be II and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5 for major defects and 15.0 for total (major and minor combined) defects.

TABLE I. End item visual defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Fabric	Any hole, cut, or tear	X	
	Broken or missing yarn, or open place clearly visible at normal inspection distance (approximately 3 feet)	X	
	Shade bar		X
Tape and webbings	Not firmly and tightly woven; edges frayed or scalloped	X	
	Multiple floats		X
	Any cut, hole, tear, or smash	X	
	Abrasion mark, slub, broken end, or pick		X
	Ends not fused as specified (where required)		X

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TABLE I. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Hardware (Bolts, nuts, washers, and rivets)	Broken	X	
	Malformed:		
	- fails to perform intended function	X	
	- but will perform intended function		X
	Any burr or sharp edge	X	
	Missing, damaged:		
	- one		X
	- two or more	X	
	Not type or size specified		X
	Any evidence of rust or corrosion	X	
	Bolt or nut loose, washer missing		X
	Rivet not securely set or neatly headed	X	
	Rivet length insufficient for peening or rolling as applicable	X	
End clips	Improperly clinched, i.e., webbing not flat at point of entrance into clips	X	
	Clinched excessively tight, cutting webbing or loosely clinched, i.e., clip becomes disengaged from webbing	X	
Steel stampings (L's, S's & T's)	Not riveted or bolted as specified on applicable drawings	X	
	Not fitted tightly against adjacent parts		X
	Not finished as specified	X	
	Any evidence of corrosion, exposed bare metal, or bare spots	X	
Seams and stitching	Open seam:		
	- for more than 1/4 inch but not more than 1/2 inch		X
	- for more than 1/2 inch	X	
NOTE:	A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken or when one or more skipped or runoff stitches occur. On double stitched seams, a seam shall be classified as open when either one or both sides of a seam are open.		

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TABLE I. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Classification Minor
Seams and stitching (cont'd)	Raw edge:		
	- more than 3/4 inch but not more than 1-1/2 inches		X
	- more than 1-1/2 inches	X	
	Thread break overstitched less than 1 inch		X
	Needle chew resulting in cut or tear longer than 1/8 inch in length, or larger than 1/8 inch in diameter	X	
	One or more required rows of stitching omitted (except on boxstitching)	X	
Boxstitching	Incomplete:		
	- one row of stitching omitted		X
	- two or more rows of stitching omitted	X	
Seam type	Wrong seam type	X	
Stitch type	Wrong stitch type	X	
Stitch tension	Loose, resulting in an exposed bobbin thread for more than 2 inches		X
	Tight, as evidenced by puckering of fabric for more than 2 inches		X
Stitches per inch	Less than minimum specified:		
	- one stitch		X
	- two or more stitches	X	
	One or more stitches in excess of maximum specified		X
	NOTE: Variation in the number of stitches per inch at corners shall be classified as follows: a. Within the minor defect classification - no defect b. Within the major defect classification - minor defect		
Stitching margin; stitching gage	Not as specified		X

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TABLE I. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Stitching ends	Overstitched less than 1 inch (except when ends are held down by other stitching, turned under in a hem or where stitching is performed automatically)		X
	Secured with less than three tying, overlapping or backstitches when automatic stitching is performed		X
Hems	Twisted or pleated		X
	Constructed with partial turnunder when double turnunder is required		X
Securing patch (when required)	Missing	X	
Binding	Loosely applied but not exposing raw edge of material		X
	Loosely applied exposing raw edge of material	X	
Frame	Bent or deformed	X	
	Dented	X	
	Any sharp edge, burr, or sliver	X	
End rail	Hole for dowel plug missing, not drilled as specified	X	
	Hole for spacer plug missing or not drilled as specified	X	
	Stay missing	X	
	Stay not firmly fixed with blind rivet		
Leg, long	Strap, buckle or end clip missing	X	
	Strap not securely fastened to leg	X	
End plug	Not securely fastened in place		X
	One missing		X
	More than one missing	X	
Spacer plug	Missing	X	
Dowel plug	Missing	X	

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TABLE I. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Assembly	Cot cannot be fully opened	X	
	Cot cannot be easily closed or compactly folded	X	
	Any component not material specified	X	
	Any component part or operation omitted (unless otherwise classified herein)	X	
Marking	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, or misplaced		X
Cleanness	Grease or oil stains, thread ends not trimmed to 1/4 inch or less		X

4.2.4 End item dimensional examination. The end item shall be examined for conformance to the specified dimensions. Any dimension not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one cot. The sample unit shall be one cot. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0.

4.2.5 Packaging inspection. An examination shall be made to determine that preservation, packing and marking requirements comply with section 5. Defects shall be as specified in table II. The sample unit shall be two completely wrapped cots fully packaged. The lot shall be the number of completely wrapped cots offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

TABLE II. Packaging defects

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and exterior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; or improper size, location, sequence, or method of application
Materials	Any component missing, damaged or not as specified
Contents	Number of cots per container is more or less than specified
Workmanship	Inadquate application of components such as loose strapping

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4.2.6 Palletization examination. When palletization is required, an examination shall be made to determine that palletization complies with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be as specified in table III. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load fully packaged. The lot shall be the number of palletized unit loads in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

TABLE III. Palletization defects

Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeding specified maximum requirements
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified Interlocking of loads not as specified Load not bonded with required straps as specified
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A.

5.1.1 Level A. Each cot shall be folded as shown in steps 1 through 9 of Drawing 2-5-65.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Two cots, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be nested in the most compact manner as shown in step 10, Drawing 2-5-65. The two nested cots shall be wrapped with a double thickness of kraft paper, basis weight 60 pounds (24 by 36-500) conforming to type I of UU-P-268, to completely encircle the bundle as follows: The kraft paper shall be 72 inches long by 48 inches wide, folded to form a double sheet 36 inches long by 48 inches wide. Two sheets 36 inches by 48 inches may be used. The side edges of the double sheet shall be folded in for a distance of 8 inches on each side so as to make a double sheet 36 inches long by 32 inches wide; the folded sheet shall then be wrapped around the two cots as shown in steps 11 and 12, Drawing 2-5-65, and strapped with two steel straps, 1/2 by 0.15 inch, conforming to type I, class A of QQ-S-781. Each strap shall be placed approximately 8 inches from each end of the bundle.

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5.2.2 Commercial packing. Cots, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with MIL-STD-1188.

5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), cots packed as specified shall be palletized in accordance with load type I of MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L. Pallet patterns shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course.

5.4 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with 5.4.1 or 5.4.2 as specified (see 6.2).

5.4.1 Civil agencies. Two tags shall be wired to each bundle (one to each steel strap) with not less than 0.036-inch diameter annealed wire. The tags and marking shall be in accordance with FED-STD-123 or MIL-STD-1188, as applicable.

5.4.2 Military requirements. Two tags shall be wired to each bundle (one to each steel strap) with not less than 0.036-inch diameter annealed wie. The tags and markings shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or MIL-STD-1188, as applicable.

6. NOTES.

6.1 Intended use. The cot covered by this specification is used in field camps and other temporary quarters.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Selection of applicable levels of packing (see 5.2).
(c) When palletization is required (see 5.3).
(d) Type marking required (see 5.4).

6.3 Insect net pole supports. Insect netting and wood pole supports conforming to MIL-I-82265 and MIL-P-17662, respectively, may be used on the cot covered by this specification.

6.4 Standard pack (Civil agencies). The standard pack for this commodity shall be as specified in 5.2.1. The standard pack requirements are intended for use in procurements of stores' stock replenishments. Procuring officers should use the standard pack requirements when it is known that the material will be shipped from a supplier to a domestic warehouse, supply depot, or immediate storage point for temporary storage, subsequent issue or shipment to eventual user.

6.5 Commercial products. The United Shoe Machinery Corporation's "Pop" rivet AD66ABSLF has been found satisfactory to meet the requirements of 3.1.1.

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6.6 Recycled material. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirements of the specification (see 3.1).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - YD
Air Force - 99

Review activities

Army - MD
Navy - MC
Air Force - 84
DLA - GS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

GSA - OPP
JUS - FPI

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

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